

Spine Care Associates

Initial Visit Note | May 15, 2026 | MRN: MEM-4401

Patient: Robert Chen | DOB: 1972-08-15 | Age: 52 male

Diagnosis: progressive lower back pain with left L5 radiculopathy (M54.16)

CPT: 72148 | NPI: 1234567890

History of Present Illness

Robert Chen is a 52-year-old male presenting with progressive lower back pain with left L5 radiculopathy. Symptoms duration: approximately 9 weeks. Physical exam: positive SLR at 30° left, diminished ankle reflex left, decreased pinprick L5 dermatome left. Medications tried: ibuprofen 800mg TID, gabapentin 300mg TID. PT completed: 16 sessions.

Assessment

Primary: M54.16 — progressive lower back pain with left L5 radiculopathy. Medical necessity established. Conservative measures exhausted. Recommend proceeding.

Plan

1. Submit prior authorization for CPT 72148 2. Continue current management pending approval 3. Follow-up in 2-4 weeks 4. Patient educated on procedure/treatment risks and benefits

Electronically signed | Doc ID: aef2a076-5ae8-49f7-8185-2a75848103a0 | Category: radiology-lumbar-mri | Outcome: approve